

# Aesthetic Computer

## Personal Computers Are Not Done Yet

Jeffrey Alan Scudder · LACMA Art + Technology Lab 2026 · Detailed Project Budget

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|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| Artist fee (24 months, Fall 2026 to Fall 2028)                                                                          | \$22,000        |
| Studio hardware (dev machines, displays)                                                                                | \$3,500         |
| AC Device Library fleet (12 AC Blank laptops × \$128 flashed with Aesthetic.Computer, incl. cases + shipping + returns) | \$2,000         |
| Mini Rig portable speakers for installation (5 × \$120)                                                                 | \$600           |
| USB drives, cables, peripherals                                                                                         | \$500           |
| Installation fabrication (furniture, mounts)                                                                            | \$2,500         |
| Workshop materials (printed guides, KidLisp reference cards)                                                            | \$1,200         |
| <b>2027 Symposium “boot the cohort”</b> (cohort demo USB kit, on-site workshop station, travel)                         | \$2,500         |
| <b>2028 Demo Day “play the room”</b> (multi-station install setup, public-program support, v1.0 release)                | \$3,000         |
| <b>Paid event helpers</b> (workshop TAs, install + take-down at Symposium and Demo Day)                                 | \$3,000         |
| Server + compute infrastructure (hosting, CDN, CI/CD)                                                                   | \$3,500         |
| Documentation production (video, photography, translation)                                                              | \$2,000         |
| Contingency (10%)                                                                                                       | \$3,700         |
| <hr/>                                                                                                                   |                 |
| <b>Total Requested</b>                                                                                                  | <b>\$50,000</b> |

The 10% contingency line handles budget slip; paid helpers are a direct expense budgeted for the cohort’s two public events. Other funding: open-source sponsorship via GitHub Sponsors and Lib-erapay supplements ongoing infrastructure costs (hosting, domains, CI). Personal / studio funds cover primary ongoing support.

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## Milestones & disbursement by phase

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|------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|
| Fall 2026 to Spring 2027     | <b>Library Build-Out &amp; Curriculum.</b> Establish the AC Device Library (12 AC Blanks, lending-fleet infrastructure, waitlist software), design the 3-level KidLisp workshop curriculum, produce printed reference cards.                                                      | \$10,000              |
| Spring to Summer 2027        | <b>First Library Cohort + Pilots.</b> Open the library waitlist; 2 pilot Flash Days at LACMA; first public borrowing cycle; prototype multi-station installation; v0 open-source build guide.                                                                                     | \$8,000               |
| Fall 2027                    | <b>2027 Symposium “We boot the cohort.”</b> Cohort artists and library members flash AC Blanks together and take them home. Public KidLisp workshop; talk alongside the 2023 cohort.                                                                                              | \$7,000               |
| Winter 2027 to Summer 2028   | <b>Library Scaling + Extended Workshops.</b> Kiosk-mode hardening, library curriculum v1 (EN + ES), 4 additional workshops, returns-and-repair cycle for the fleet, complete documentation of the waitlist and lending system.                                                    | \$15,000              |
| Fall 2028                    | <b>2028 Demo Day “We play the room.”</b> Multi-station Aesthetic.Computer installation premieres on the LACMA floor; Family Play afternoons open the library fleet to visitors of any age; v1.0 of the open-source build pipeline ships, so any institution can run its own room. | \$10,000              |
| <hr/> <b>Total Requested</b> |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | <hr/> <b>\$50,000</b> |